

11.2.18 Matgeo

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Question

The line segment joining the mid-points of any two sides of a triangle is parallel to the third side and is half of it.

Let ABC be the triangle ,
 $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{F}$ be the midpoints of AB and BC respectively .

$$\mathbf{E} = \frac{A + B}{2} \quad (1)$$

$$\mathbf{F} = \frac{B + C}{2} \quad (2)$$

Solution

The line joining these two points is

$$\mathbf{EF} = \frac{\mathbf{C} - \mathbf{A}}{2} \quad (3)$$

The line AC is

$$\mathbf{AC} = \mathbf{C} - \mathbf{A} \quad (4)$$

Hence ,

$$\mathbf{EF} = \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{AC} \quad (5)$$

Therefore the line segment joining the mid-points of any two sides of a triangle is parallel to the third side and is half of it